

Self-Assessment: A Private Mirror

Write this for no one but yourself. Honesty matters more than polish.

When a prompt feels uncomfortable, that discomfort is usually the signal you're getting close to something true. Don't smooth it over.

Date started: _____ Last updated: _____

1. The Factual Baseline

The raw mechanics of your life. Easy to fill in, but they quietly shape everything else.

- Age / stage of life:
- Where I live (and how I feel about it):
- What I do (work / study / caregiving / other):
- Typical wake time: _____ Typical bedtime: _____
- Hours of sleep I actually get: _____ (and how rested I feel:)
- A normal weekday, hour by hour:
- A normal weekend:
- What I eat on a typical day:
- How much I move my body in a week:
- Where my money actually goes (top 3 categories):
- How much time I spend on my phone / screens per day:

Notice: Do these mechanics match the life I think I'm living? Where's the biggest gap between what I assume and what's actually true?

2. Values — What I Actually Care About

Not what I should care about. What my behavior reveals.

- Three things I claim matter most to me:
 - Where my time and money actually go:
 - The honest gap between those two lists:
 - A decision I made recently — what did it reveal about my real priorities?
 - Whose approval am I unconsciously chasing? Is that still worth it?
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3. Strengths & Triumphs (Written Specifically)

"I'm hardworking" tells you nothing. A specific story tells you everything.

- **A concrete thing I achieved that I'm proud of (what exactly did I do?):**
 - **A hard thing I got through:**
 - **What kind of effort comes naturally to me?**
 - **When do other people rely on me, and for what?**
 - **A strength I have that I tend to dismiss or take for granted:**
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4. Weaknesses & Recurring Failures

The hardest section, and the most valuable. Look for patterns, not one-off mistakes.

- **Something I keep promising to fix and don't:**
- **A way I reliably sabotage myself:**
- **Situations where I behave worse than I'd like (when? with whom?):**
- **A habit I know is costing me — and what it's costing:**
- **The "why" behind one of these: when does it show up, and what triggers it?**

Notice: Which of these is a genuine weakness, and which is just a story I've gotten comfortable repeating?

5. Emotional Landscape

- **What reliably lifts my mood / energizes me:**
 - **What reliably drains me:**
 - **What I'm genuinely afraid of:**
 - **What I avoid — and what the avoidance costs me:**
 - **When do I most often feel anxious, resentful, or restless?**
 - **The last time I felt fully like myself — what was happening?**
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6. Relationships

A lot of identity is relational. A portrait of "me alone" misses half the picture.

- The people who matter most to me:
 - Relationships I'm neglecting:
 - Where I give too much / too little:
 - The role I tend to play (fixer, avoider, peacemaker, people-pleaser, etc.):
 - A relationship I'd like to repair or deepen:
 - What do the people closest to me consistently tell me about myself? Is there truth in it?
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7. The Stories I Tell About Myself

We all carry narratives. Some are true, some are outdated, some are just convenient.

- "I'm the kind of person who always _____ / never _____":
 - A belief about myself I inherited from childhood or my upbringing:
 - A story that's quietly holding me back:
 - Which of these stories is actually true? Which is outdated? Which is an excuse?
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8. Aspirations & the Gap

- Where I want to be in 1 year:
 - Where I want to be in 5 years:
 - The honest distance between that and where I am now:
 - What I'm actually doing about it (vs. just wishing):
 - The single smallest next step I could take this week:
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9. Patterns Across the Whole Picture

Come back to this after filling in everything above. Don't read each section in isolation.

- A theme that shows up in more than one section:
 - A contradiction I notice (e.g., I value X but spend my time on Y):
 - The one change that would improve the most areas at once:
 - If a kind, honest friend read all of this, what would they gently point out?
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10. Review Cadence

The real value comes from updating this and seeing what changed.

- **Next review date:** _____ (suggested: every 3 months)
- **At each review, ask:**
 - What changed since last time?
 - What stayed exactly the same? (often the most telling)
 - Which "weakness" have I quietly outgrown?
 - Which one have I stubbornly kept?

A single snapshot tells you who you are today. A series of them tells you which direction you're moving — and that's the thing actually worth knowing.